

EnglishPod365 0298

The Office - Presentation Series 10 - The Q and A Session

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Complete lesson transcript

Hello everyone and welcome to EnglishPod. My name is Marco.

My name is Catherine and for those of you who have been following, this is the very last episode of our 10-part series about giving a presentation in English.

That's right. This is part 10 where we are going to receive questions from the audience.

So this is called a Q&A session or question and answer session. Let's take a listen to our dialogue. We'll be back in a moment.

Well everyone, I'm sure you'd like to join me in thanking Michael for what was a really inspirational presentation. Sincere thanks, Michael. Now I'm sure many of you will be keen to ask some questions, so I'd like to open up a Q&A session. Please raise your hand if you have any questions at all. Yes, Janice, go ahead.

Yes, thank you, Jonathan. I would just like to go back to the comment Mr. Ford made in regards to our competitors, particularly Orange. Now as you know, Orange has established themselves as the market leader in the high-end laptop market. How does Mr. Ford expect to compete with a company that has such a huge reputation and huge resources?

Well Janice, first of all, thanks for a very good question. I think you have hit the nail on the head actually. Orange are the global leaders precisely because of their size and power. But although we can't compete in terms of size, I do believe we hold an advantage in terms of dedication to customer service. Yes, I admit this is a David and Goliath battle, but don't forget who won that contest.

Mr. Ford, could you elaborate on actual technical details of the X420 a little more?

I'd love to, but I think we're a little pressed for time right now. However, Jonathan has all the technical specs for you on the PowerPoint presentation, which you can look over in your own time.

Mr. Ford, one final question. Would you like to join me for a game of golf this Sunday?

All right, we're back. So now let's take a look at some words on Language Takeaway.

Language Takeaway.

Well, at the beginning of today's dialogue, Jonathan said, I'm sure many of you will be

keen to ask some questions. What does this word keen mean?

All right. So to be keen to do something, which basically means that you want to or would like to do something.

Right. Are you keen? Would you like to do it? Are you interested in doing it?

Now, this is a very British form of addressing something, right?

That's right. This is very British. We don't really say this as much in America, but you can. People will understand you. I would say, I'm sure many of you would like to ask some questions and so you could say that both ways.

That's right. That's right. Okay. So many people want to ask questions and Jonathan said, so I'd like to open it up to a Q&A session. So the series of words here, to open it up to a Q&A session. What does that mean?

To open it up. It means the discussion. So he would like to invite people to ask questions. So I'd like to open it up for questions mean I would like to give you guys the opportunity to ask.

So to open up a discussion or to open up a conversation, right?

I would like to open this up to you guys.

Okay. Now, one of the audience members asked about another company, which is their competitors and said that they have a huge reputation and huge resources, this competitor. So what is this word reputation?

Reputation is important. A person can have a reputation, but a company can also have a reputation. Now, reputation means the way that other people talk about you. Okay. So he has a good reputation means people say good things about him. Or the media like newspapers and websites, they say good things about him. But if you have a bad reputation, it means people are saying bad things about you.

Right. Okay. So that pretty much sums it up a reputation, what other people say about you or how other people see you. So maybe if a company like this has a huge reputation, it means that it's very well respected and people talk very good thing and people talk well about this company.

That's right.

Right. Now, another question came along and they wanted to know a little bit more about the technical details of this product that they are introducing. And Mr. Ford said that, you know what, right now we don't really have time, but I'm going to leave all the technical specs on this PowerPoint presentation and you can look at it later.

Okay. So specs, this is something you'll hear very, very often, especially in technical

areas, but it means specifications or details. So maybe I have a computer and I know it's an IBM computer, but I don't know the specs. I don't have the details. So that's something that you would want to find out if you have a problem or you want to look into it more closely. And so specs.

That's right. Okay. So these are the specs. Now, why don't we take a break? Let's take a look at our dialogue again and we'll be back in a bit.

Well everyone, I'm sure you'd like to join me in thanking Michael for what was a really inspirational presentation. Sincere thanks, Michael. Now I'm sure many of you will be keen to ask some questions. So I'd like to open up a Q and A session. Please raise your hand if you have any questions at all. Yes, Janice, go ahead.

Yes. Thank you, Jonathan. I would just like to go back to the comment Mr. Ford made in regards to our competitors, particularly Orange. Now, as you know, Orange has established themselves as the market leader in the high-end laptop market. How does Mr. Ford expect to compete with a company that has such a huge reputation and huge resources?

Well Janice, first of all, thanks for a very good question. I think you have hit the nail on the head, actually. Orange are the global leaders precisely because of their size and power. But although we can't compete in terms of size, I do believe we hold an advantage in terms of dedication to customer service. Yes, I admit this is a David and Goliath battle, but don't forget who won that contest.

Mr. Ford, could you elaborate on extra technical details of the X420 a little more?

I'd love to, but I think we're a little pressed for time right now. However, Jonathan has all the technical specs for you on the PowerPoint presentation, which you can look over in your own time.

Mr. Ford, one final question. Would you like to join me for a game of golf this Sunday?

Alright, we're back. So now let's take a look at some of those phrases on Fluency Builder.

The first phrase we have here is one that I really like and I use very often. It's,

I think you have hit the nail on the head.

That's right. To hit the nail on the head. So this is a very common phrase, which basically means I think you got it exactly right.

Okay. So think about a nail that you're hammering something, you have a hammer in your hand.

It's very easy to miss, but boom, when you hit it, hit the nail on the head, it means you have it exactly right.

That's right. So this was actually a response to one of the questions because it was a very good question and it had a valid point. So this is why Mr. Ford said you hit the nail

on the head. This is exactly right. I completely agree with you.

After that though, we had this interesting phrase. He said, I admit this is a David and Goliath battle.

Okay. So now this is obviously, he's speaking metaphorically, right?

That's right. So David and Goliath, that's actually a story that we often talk about.

It's a biblical story, so it comes from Christianity and David and Goliath fought, but David was very, very small and Goliath was a monster. He was very big. And so everyone said Goliath will win the fight, but David won the fight. And so this is an example or a story that people often use when they say, listen, it may be the case that you think the big giants will win, but actually the small man or our small company will win.

That's right. As you said, we many times make reference to this, even not in the biblical sense, but it's just the size. Maybe we're a small company, we're going to fight this big company. So we say it's a David and Goliath battle or even athletes, maybe two boxers. One is bigger than the other. So they'll say it's a David and Goliath boxing match.

That's right.

Okay. Now when we got the questions about the technical details of the computer, Mr. Ford said that we are a little bit pressed for time right now. That's why we can't really answer that question.

That's right. And so to be pressed for time means that you don't have a lot of time. You are in a rush.

That's right. So if you are pressed for time, you don't have too much time. You can't, you're in a hurry basically.

So I could say, Hey Marco, can you come here and look at this thing on my computer please?

I'm sorry. I'm a little bit pressed for time right now. I'll take a look at it in an hour.

Okay. So those are all of our phrases from Fluency Builder. Let's take another listen to our dialogue and we'll be right back.

Hello everyone. I'm sure you'd like to join me in thanking Michael for what was a really inspirational presentation. Sincere thanks Michael. Now I'm sure many of you will be keen to ask some questions. So I'd like to open up a Q and A session. Please raise your hand if you have any questions at all. Yes, Janice, go ahead.

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Mr. Ford, one final question. Would you like to join me for a game of golf this Sunday?

Alright so that was part 10 of our 10-part series about presentations. We took a look at many different aspects where you can take it as an example as we talked about computers and marketing, but you can more or less have an idea of how a presentation should go and the type of vocab you can use. That's right, and I think that this particular dialogue today was very, very useful because a lot of times you're going to have people asking you questions and filling in details, and so you can use some of these phrases to help explain exactly what your presentation was about when people do have questions.

That's right. So we hope that you enjoyed this series and we would like to hear from you if you have any other suggestions about a series of dialogues or a series of lessons that we can do. We had one about a job interview, all the steps and everything, how a job interview would go. We just had a series about presentations, so maybe you can give us some feedback or some ideas of what you would like to learn. Let us know. Our website is EnglishPod.com.

We'll see you there. Alright, bye.

Bye.